

Telecom Clicker

How to play · What the game does · Pacing design

What the Game Is

Telecom Clicker is a clicker/idle game where you build a telecom empire from **1880** (hand-crank switchboards) all the way to the **interspace era** (quantum repeaters, lunar relays). You click to earn cash, research real telecom history, build infrastructure in world regions, fight rival companies, and take the company public.

Time flows fast: **1 real hour = 1 game year**. An entire run spans 6 technological eras, and each era is paced to take roughly **6–7 hours of play** on the fastest legal path.

The Six Eras

#	Era	Years	Signature technology
0	Analog Dawn	1880–1920	Copper trunk, manual switchboard, Morse telegraph
1	Electromechanical & Radio	1930–1960	Crossbar exchanges, microwave towers, TAT-1 submarine cable
2	Digital & Satellite	1970–1990	Fiber, digital COs, #5ESS, 1G AMPS
3	Broadband & IP	2000–2015	FTTH, LTE, DWDM, IP core routers
4	Autonomous & SDN	2015–2030	5G, LEO satellites, AI-NFV, MEC
5	Interspace	2030+	Quantum repeaters, lunar relays, interstellar gateways

The Pages (Tabs)

1. Click page

The heart of the game. Tap anywhere to earn cash (each tap = base \$5 × quality multiplier × prestige). The page shows your **Revenue** per second and **Quality** score, plus the current click value. A small circle ripples at every tap.

2. Research page

4 branches — **Transmission (T), Switching (S), Access (A), Core (C)** — form a dependency graph of 87 tech nodes. Nodes show prerequisite links; the next era is dimmed. Long-press a node for details (quality effects, RP cost, unlocks, prerequisites).

- **Research Points (RP)** are produced automatically; production scales with the R&D budget slider, laboratory level, and network revenue.
- Each era requires a minimum number of nodes in *every* branch (4 per branch) to advance to the next era.
- Upgrading the **laboratory** permanently raises the RP investment cap and production.

3. Expand page

12 world regions (North America → Arctic/Nordic). Each region has a **foothold %** (market share) that multiplies its income.

- Enter new regions for a fixed cost (grows per region).
- Boost foothold +1% at a time — price rises as it grows.
- **Rivals** appear per region with their own tech, infra, and quality; they steal market share and apply pressure that reduces your income and foothold growth.

4. Infra page

Build the physical network that actually earns money. Assets are unlocked by research and grouped by era. Buy in bulk ($\times 1/\times 5/\times 10/\times 25$).

Income formula: **income = infrastructure base × technology multiplier × regional market × prestige**

5. Finance page

- **IPO** — after researching ANI (C10) with >\$500/year revenue you can sell 30% of the company for a big cash injection; buy back shares later. Drop below 20% ownership and shareholders may remove you (game over / rebirth trigger).
- **Bank** — credit limit = revenue/s × 1,800. Borrow 25/50/ max, repay whenever. Interest compounds monthly; the annual rate re-rolls every 3 game months (2.7%–3.3%).

6. Ads (Expand → Advertisement)

10 ad channels from newspaper (1880) to streaming (2016). Each channel may spend up to 1% of current network revenue per second; every \$1/s spent brings +1 subscriber/s. Subscribers grow your user base (demand).

7. Contracts (Expand → Contract)

Offers appear every ~60 seconds: monthly cash payments for 6–12 months plus a foothold boost, often letting you enter a region early. Expire on a real timer; max 2 pending + 3 active.

8. Settings menu (≡)

Language switcher (English / 한국어), and an "Ad for \$1000" button (placeholder — coming soon, currently non-functional).

Core Loop & Currencies

Currency	How you get it	What it buys
Cash	Clicking + network income	Infrastructure, expansion, foothold, laboratory, ads, IPO/loans

RP	Auto production (budget/lab/revenue)	Tech nodes → unlocks
Users	Organic growth + ads	Demand for your network
Quality	Researched nodes + built infra	Revenue multiplier $\times (1 + \text{quality}/100)$

Golden rule: research unlocks infrastructure, infrastructure earns cash, cash funds research. Rivals and market pressure punish stagnation.

Play-Time Design (Why ~6 Hours per Era)

The pacing was tuned deliberately so each era takes about **6–7 hours** of active play to clear on the fastest legal tech path, with the whole game (6 eras) lasting ~40 hours. Two levers make this work:

1. RP costs are scaled to era time budgets

For every era, the cheapest legal research path has a known RP weight (`ERA_MIN_PATH_WEIGHTS` : 239 → 581 → 815 → 1058 → 960). The cost of each node is scaled so that a player sitting exactly at the era's RP cap takes **~7 simulated hours** to collect the whole path:

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research cost = node RP × (era RP cap × 7h ÷ path weight)
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2. RP caps and carryover protect the pace

- Each era caps RP production (`ERA_RP_CAPS` : 8 → 12 → 18 → 27 → 40/s). You cannot out-farm an era.
- When you advance eras, at most **30 minutes' worth** of RP carries over (`ERA_RP_CARRY_SECONDS`) — enough for a quick start, not enough to skip the next era.
- Spending 30% of revenue in ads, lab upgrades, and a healthy budget slider accelerates research — but the cap keeps the total bounded.

3. Real-time scaling

1 real hour = 1 game year. Rivals enter on a year-based probability curve (3% before 1900 → 20% after 1980), contracts and bank interest tick monthly, and the whole economy runs in real time in the background — even the text edition of the game simulates income while you type.

Why it matters: 6 hours per era means every era feels like a full session. You experience each technological era at a meaningful pace — fast enough to stay engaged, slow enough to feel the progression from copper wire to quantum repeaters.